Daniel Webala

Software Engineer · Full-stack, React Native & DevOps

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https://webala.dev

PROFILE

Software engineer with 5+ years building production web, mobile and backend systems, from a multi-tenant point-of-sale SaaS and a real-time gaming platform to ride-hailing apps and a video pipeline. Comfortable owning a system end to end: data model, services, clients, CI/CD and monitoring. Works in TypeScript and Python across React, Next.js, React Native, Node.js and Django, mostly with remote teams.

EXPERIENCE

Apr 2026 — Present CONTRACT Nairobi, Kenya

React Native Engineer · Grabride

- Build the rider and driver apps in React Native and TypeScript on Expo SDK 57 and React Native 0.86 (New Architecture) with Expo Router, NativeWind and Gluestack UI.
- Designed the driver onboarding and KYC flow: multi-step driver and vehicle details, document uploads, a selfie and liveness check, and a verification status flow so drivers can only go online once approved.
- Ride booking, taxi type selection, driver matching, trip tracking and live ETA on Google Maps Platform (Maps SDK, Routes API), with Firebase, Google Sign-In, push notifications and background location for drivers.
- Typed API layer with TanStack Query and Axios, request throttling and rate limiting; forms with React Hook Form and schema validation.

Jun 2025 — May 2026 CONTRACT Nairobi, Kenya

Software Engineer · BeatBnk Limited

- Integrated M-Pesa and Paystack payment gateways into the Node.js backend: 1,000+ transactions in the first month at a 99.9% success rate.
- Made payment processing idempotent, eliminating double charges and cutting transaction error rates by 25%.
- Built the KYC flow: ID document upload during onboarding, a pending / approved / rejected verification status flow, and admin review tools for staff.
- Streamlined message-queue processing in the backend, reducing latency by 15% for real-time data updates.

Jun 2025 — Dec 2025 CONTRACT Nairobi, Kenya

Tech Lead · Mothan Technologies (Cheddaz Bet)

- Owned architecture decisions (stack, service design, data model, infrastructure), code review and coding standards for a team of 2–3 engineers.
- Django backend with ledger accounts for user and system balances, cutting reconciliation time by 20%.
- Near-real-time bet updates with 90% lower latency for 10,000+ concurrent users; asynchronous task processing brought average response times down 25%.
- Automated odds and sports data sync with cron jobs (manual intervention down 90%) and bet settlement scripts that made settlement 50% faster and saved 15 hours a week of manual work.

Nov 2024 — Jul 2025 CONTRACT Nairobi, Kenya

Software Engineer · VideoElf

- Engineered a video aggregation pipeline with yt-dlp, Celery and Redis for parallel downloads, raising processing throughput by 40%.
- Modular Next.js front end with a reusable component architecture: codebase 50% smaller, pages 30% faster to load.
- Design system applied across 5 product modules, cutting UI-related bug reports by 25%.
- CI/CD with Docker and PM2 took release cycles from 2 days to under 2 hours; backend logging and monitoring cut average error resolution time by 35%.

Jan 2024 — Jul 2025 EMPLOYMENT Nairobi, Kenya

Software Engineer · Ah Khul Limited

- Developed a RESTful API using Express.js and Node.js, reducing server response time by 40% and improving overall platform performance.
- Engineered a React-based user interface for 2D games, resulting in a 30% increase in user engagement and a 20% reduction in bounce rate.
- Integrated M-Pesa payment gateway, processing over 10,000 transactions in the first month with a 99.99% success rate.
- Led a team of 4 engineers in implementing JWT authentication across all gaming platforms, enhancing security and reducing unauthorized access attempts by 60%.

May 2021 — Dec 2024 EMPLOYMENT Nairobi, Kenya

Frontend Developer · Space Ya Tech

- Built 15+ reusable React components for MentorIst, making UI development 20% faster.
- Led a team of 3 engineers to build MentorIst's in-app chat, lifting user engagement 30% in its first month.
- REST API data fetching with client-side caching, bringing average response times down 40%.
- Mentored 5 junior engineers in React through the MentorIst mentorship program; their code quality scores rose 25% within 6 weeks.

EDUCATION

Sep 2024 — Present Nairobi, Kenya

Strathmore University

Bachelor's Degree, Business Information Technology (in progress)

SKILLS

Languages	TypeScript JavaScript Python SQL HTML, CSS, SCSS
Web	React Next.js TanStack Query TanStack Table React Hook Form Zod Tailwind CSS Vite
Mobile	React Native Expo Expo Router EAS iOS App Store and Google Play releases
Backend and APIs	Node.js Express Django Django REST Framework REST API design WebSockets (Socket.IO, Django Channels) Microservices Message queues Celery Prisma
Data	PostgreSQL Supabase Redis MongoDB
Infrastructure and DevOps	Docker GitHub Actions CI/CD Linux Nginx reverse proxy SSL/TLS, firewall and VPS hardening PM2 Prometheus Grafana AWS (EC2, S3, RDS) GCP (Maps Platform, Firebase) Cloudflare R2 Vercel
Testing	Jest Vitest Supertest Playwright pytest
Security and payments	JWT and token auth HMAC and public-key request signing Row-level security M-Pesa Paystack